National TVET Excellence Awards 2026

Scoring System: How Everything Works, Including Refreshing and Auditor Access

A reference guide for organisers and the panel, written so that questions about the scoring app, its rules and its security can be answered quickly and consistently.

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1. Purpose and overview

The scoring app lets the judging panel score every nominee against the same six criteria, with written reasons, and gives the organisers a ranked, auditable result. Judges score on any device through a web page. Nothing is stored on the judge's device; every score is saved straight to a Google Sheet owned by the organisers.

Scoring opens after Portfolio of Evidence (PoE) submissions close on 11 October 2026.

2. Who does what

Role	Signs in with	Can do
Administrator	Admin PIN	Manage nominees and judges, change settings, see all scores and the ranked results, import nominees, clear test data, view the change log.
Judge	Their name and personal 4-digit code	See the nominee list and nomination details, declare a conflict of interest, score nominees with written reasons, and change their own submitted scores (with a reason).
Auditor (Legal Services, Internal Audit)	Their name and personal 4-digit code	Read-only. Open the Results page and see the ranked results, every judge's scores with written reasons, the change log, conflicts declared and the full nomination details. Cannot score, edit, add or delete anything.
Visitor (not signed in)	Nothing	Sees only the total number of nominees. No names, categories, scores or judge names.

3. How the system is built

Three parts work together:

- **The web page** (a single file, *index.html*) hosted on Vercel from a GitHub repository. This is what judges and the admin see.
- **A Google Apps Script** (*Code.gs*) published as a web app. It is the gatekeeper: it checks who is asking, decides what they may see, and writes to the sheet.
- **A Google Sheet** that holds all the data. It is the single source of truth.

The page talks to the script through one address, **SHEET_URL**, which must be the script.google.com ... /exec address of the current deployment. If the script is redeployed under a new address, SHEET_URL in the repository must be updated. Because the script does all permission checks on the server, hiding something in the page alone is never relied on for privacy.

Because many people use the app at the same time, the page does not hold the data itself. It asks the script for the latest data whenever it needs it (see the section on refreshing).

The live version is the master. Changes are requested as notes to the organiser, not as replacement files, so versions do not drift apart.

4. Refreshing: how the page stays up to date

The Google Sheet is the only record. Nothing is kept on a judge's or administrator's device. The page on screen is therefore only a **snapshot** of the sheet at the moment it was last fetched. Judges, the administrator and the auditors all use the app at the same time, so the sheet can change while a page is open. Refreshing is how a page fetches a new snapshot.

4.1 Why refreshing is needed

- **Other people's work.** When a judge submits a score, the administrator and auditors will not see it until their page fetches the sheet again.
- **Correct results.** The ranking, averages, statuses (such as Awaiting judges) and wide-spread flags are calculated from the data on screen. Old data gives old results.
- **Proof that a save worked.** After every save the page re-reads the sheet, so what the judge then sees is what is actually recorded, not what was typed.

- **Safety.** The server decides who may see what, so every refresh re-checks the person's credentials. A page cannot keep fetching private data after access is removed.
- **No local copies.** Fetching from the single shared record means there is never a second, out-of-date version on someone's device.

4.2 When a refresh happens

Trigger	What happens
Opening or reloading the page	One fetch of the public information (settings and the nominee count).
Signing in (judge, admin or auditor)	A fetch using the person's credentials. The server returns only what that person may see.
After saving a score, a recusal or any admin change	The page re-reads the sheet to confirm the change and show the current state.
The Refresh button on the Results page	An immediate fetch, whenever someone wants the latest data now.
Automatic, every 2 minutes	Runs only on the Dashboard and Results pages.

4.3 Why the automatic refresh is every 2 minutes

The page used to check the sheet every 15 seconds. Every check is a request to Google, and each one makes the script read the sheet. With several people watching the Results page, that adds up to many requests every minute, which can slow the app down and risks hitting Google's usage limits at the busiest moment of the judging period. Scoring is not a live ticker: judges submit a handful of sheets per nominee, so results rarely change from second to second. Two minutes keeps the Results and Dashboard pages reasonably current while cutting the load on Google by about eight times. Anyone who needs the very latest data presses Refresh.

4.4 What the automatic refresh never does

- It never runs on the Scoring page, so a judge's work in progress is never wiped or interrupted.
- It skips a cycle while the person is typing in a field, while another request to the sheet is running, and while the browser tab is in the background.
- A refresh only reads. It never changes, adds or deletes any data.
- If a slow reply arrives after a newer one, it is ignored, so an old answer can never overwrite a newer one or undo a sign-in.

4.5 What this means in practice

A score submitted by a judge can take up to two minutes to appear on an administrator's or auditor's screen unless they press Refresh. If numbers look out of date, press Refresh before querying them. The sheet is always the master record.

5. The scoring method

5.1 Criteria and weights

Each nominee is scored on six criteria. Each criterion is a whole number from 1 to 5, and each carries a weight.

Criterion	Weight
Teaching Effectiveness	25
Student Performance	20
Industry Alignment and WIL	20
Innovation and Digital Teaching	15
Professional Development	10
Student Feedback	10
Total	100

5.2 How a judge's total is calculated

For every criterion the score is divided by the maximum (5) and multiplied by its weight. The six results are added to give a total out of 100. Example: a judge giving 4 for Teaching Effectiveness contributes 4/5 x 25 = 20 points from that criterion.

5.3 Panel average and recognition bands

A nominee needs scores from the required number of judges (three by default). The panel average is the average of the judges' totals. A nominee qualifies at 70 or above.

Panel average	Recognition
90 and above	National Excellence Winner
80 to 89	Finalist Recognition
70 to 79	Merit Recognition
Below 70	Does not qualify

5.4 Written reasons

A written reason is recorded for each criterion so that every score can be explained afterwards.

5.5 Conflict of interest and recusal

A judge who has a conflict with a nominee declares a recusal. The recusal is recorded, and any score that judge had already entered for that nominee is deleted. A recused judge does not count towards the required number of judges for that nominee.

5.6 Changing a submitted score

A judge may change a submitted score, but must give a reason. The old and new values, the reason, the judge and a server-side timestamp are written to the ChangeLog tab. Timestamps come from the server, not the judge's device, so they cannot be altered.

6. Nominees and categories

There are seven award categories:

- National TVET Lecturer of the Year
- Engineering Lecturer Excellence Award
- Business and Utility Studies Lecturer Excellence Award

- Occupational Programmes Lecturer Excellence Award
- Emerging TVET Lecturer Award
- Innovation in Teaching and Learning Award
- Work-Integrated Learning Excellence Award

6.1 The nominations workbook

The roster is based on the official nominations workbook. There is **one entry per person per award category**, so someone nominated in two categories appears twice and is scored separately in each. The initial import produced 76 entries.

On import, college names with spelling variants were standardised, exact duplicates (same name, college and category) were merged, and rows that could not safely be cleaned were left out and listed in a separate review file for the organisers to decide. The duplicate rule is name + college + category.

6.2 Nomination details

Each nominee carries extra detail fields from the workbook (for example qualifications, experience, motivation and supporting information). Judges always see these details beside the scoring form, because they are needed to score fairly.

Judges **do not** see: employee number, email, mobile number, nominator, nominator contact or nomination date. This keeps contact details private and avoids judging by who nominated someone. The administrator sees everything.

6.3 Phone numbers

Mobile numbers are stored in international format starting +27. The entry box converts numbers such as 082 123 4567 to +27 82 123 4567 automatically.

7. Privacy and security

7.1 What each person can see

Information	Visitor	Judge	Auditor	Admin
Number of nominees	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Nominee names and categories	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Judge names	Names only, for sign-in	Names only	Yes	Yes
Nomination details	No	All except contact and nominator	Yes, all	Yes, all
Their own scores	No	Yes	n/a	n/a
Other judges' scores and reasons	No	No	Yes	Yes
Ranked results	No	No	Yes	Yes
Change log and conflicts	No	Own entries only	Yes	Yes
Add, edit, delete, clear, settings	No	No	No	Yes
Admin PIN and codes	No	No	No	Yes

7.2 Signing in

Judges type their name and personal 4-digit code. Name matching ignores capital letters, spaces, dots, dashes and accents, so small typing differences do not lock a judge out. The code must be exact. Auditors sign in the same way, with their name and code from the Auditors tab, and get read-only access. The admin signs in with the admin PIN. All of these are stored in the Google Sheet and checked by the script, never by the page.

7.3 Auditor access (read-only)

Legal Services and Internal Audit reviewers have their own sign-in on the Results page. The script recognises them from the Auditors tab and gives them a read-only view. Every write action (score, recusal, nominee, settings, clear) is refused for an auditor by the server, not just hidden on the page. Their view groups every score sheet by nominee, then by judge, with the six criteria, the score for each and the judge's written reason beside it, followed by the change log and the conflicts declared.

7.4 Protection against guessing

After 10 wrong attempts for a name, sign-in for that name is blocked for 15 minutes. This slows down anyone trying to guess codes.

7.5 Other safeguards

- Every administrator action (adding, deleting, importing, clearing, settings) is checked on the server for the admin PIN.
- A formula-injection guard stops text beginning with = + - or @ from running as a spreadsheet formula.
- Updates are queued with a lock so two people saving at once cannot overwrite each other; if the server is busy the user gets a clear "Server busy" message and can retry.
- The Google Sheet itself is restricted to named organisers. Anyone with Editor access can see the admin PIN and every code, so the sheet is never shared with judges.
- Personal information (names, colleges, contact details) falls under POPIA. Access is limited to those with a need, and contact details are withheld from the panel.

8. Results and statuses

Results are visible to the administrator and to appointed auditors only. They are grouped by category and ranked by panel average, with complete nominees ahead of incomplete ones.

Status or flag	Meaning
Awaiting judges	Fewer judges have scored than the number required. No recognition is assigned yet.
Complete	The required number of judges have scored; the band is assigned from the panel average.
Wide spread	The highest and lowest judge totals differ by the spread setting (default 15) or more. A prompt for the panel to discuss before finalising.

Below the ranking, administrators and auditors see an audit trail: each nominee opens to show every judge's scores and reasons, then the changes made to submitted scores and the conflicts declared. The page refreshes automatically every 2 minutes (see the refreshing section) and has a Refresh button.

A recusal that leaves fewer judges than required keeps the nominee in "Awaiting judges"; the organiser decides how to handle that nominee.

9. The Google Sheet, tab by tab

Tab	Contents
Nominees	One row per entry: ID, name, college, category, plus the detail columns.
Scores	Each judge's six scores and reasons per nominee, with server timestamp.
ChangeLog	Every changed score: who, when, old and new values, reason.
Recusals	Declared conflicts of interest.
Judges	Judge name and personal 4-digit code.
Auditors	Auditor name and personal 4-digit code (read-only reviewers).
Settings	Maximum score, judges required, qualifying mark, spread, admin PIN and the judge name list (one per line).

Tab and column order should not be edited by hand. The script depends on their position.

10. Administrator how-to

Add or change judges

Add the names to the judge list in Settings (one per line, spelt correctly), then run **ensureCodes** in the script editor. Each judge receives a 4-digit code in the Judges tab, which is given to them privately. Judges can also be added, renamed or removed from the admin screen.

Add or change auditors

Run **setupAuditors** once in the script editor to create the Auditors tab with the two reviewers. After that, add, rename or change auditors directly in the Auditors tab (Name and Code, plain text). No redeploy is needed. Give each person their code privately.

If someone cannot sign in

- Check for a lockout: 10 wrong codes block that name for 15 minutes. Running **setupCodes** clears it.
- The name in the Judges tab must match the judge list in Settings. After editing either, run **setupCodes**.
- Codes are kept as text, so a code such as 0123 keeps its leading zero. Do not drag-fill codes down the column.
- Ask the person to hard-refresh the page (Ctrl+Shift+R) and type the name and code again.

Import nominees

Sign in as admin, open the Nominees page and choose "Import the whole list", then select the prepared workbook. Duplicates are skipped by the rule in 6.1.

Clear test data

Use the admin screen's clear-scores action. Test scores and recusals are removed; nominees and judges are kept. Do this only before scoring begins.

Changing the script and redeploying

- Edit Code.gs in the Apps Script editor and save.
- Choose Deploy, then Manage deployments, then edit the existing deployment and select **New version**. Keeping the same deployment keeps the same address.

- Access must be set to allow anyone to reach the web app (the script itself enforces permissions).
- If a brand new deployment is created, copy its /exec address into SHEET_URL in the repository.

Tell Pieter before changing SHEET_URL. The old deployment should not be archived until he confirms.

11. Known limitations

- Each fetch reads the whole sheet through Google, so a refresh can take a few seconds.
- Automatic refresh is every 2 minutes, so other people's changes can appear up to 2 minutes late unless Refresh is pressed.
- The word "Awaiting judges" also appears when a recusal leaves fewer judges than required; the organiser must decide how to proceed.
- Some nominee rows still need organiser decisions (the review list), and one phone number needs checking.
- Security rests on codes and the admin PIN. They must be shared privately and never posted in group chats.
- The system has been tested thoroughly against simulated data and a live check by the organiser; a final dry run with the panel before scoring opens is recommended.